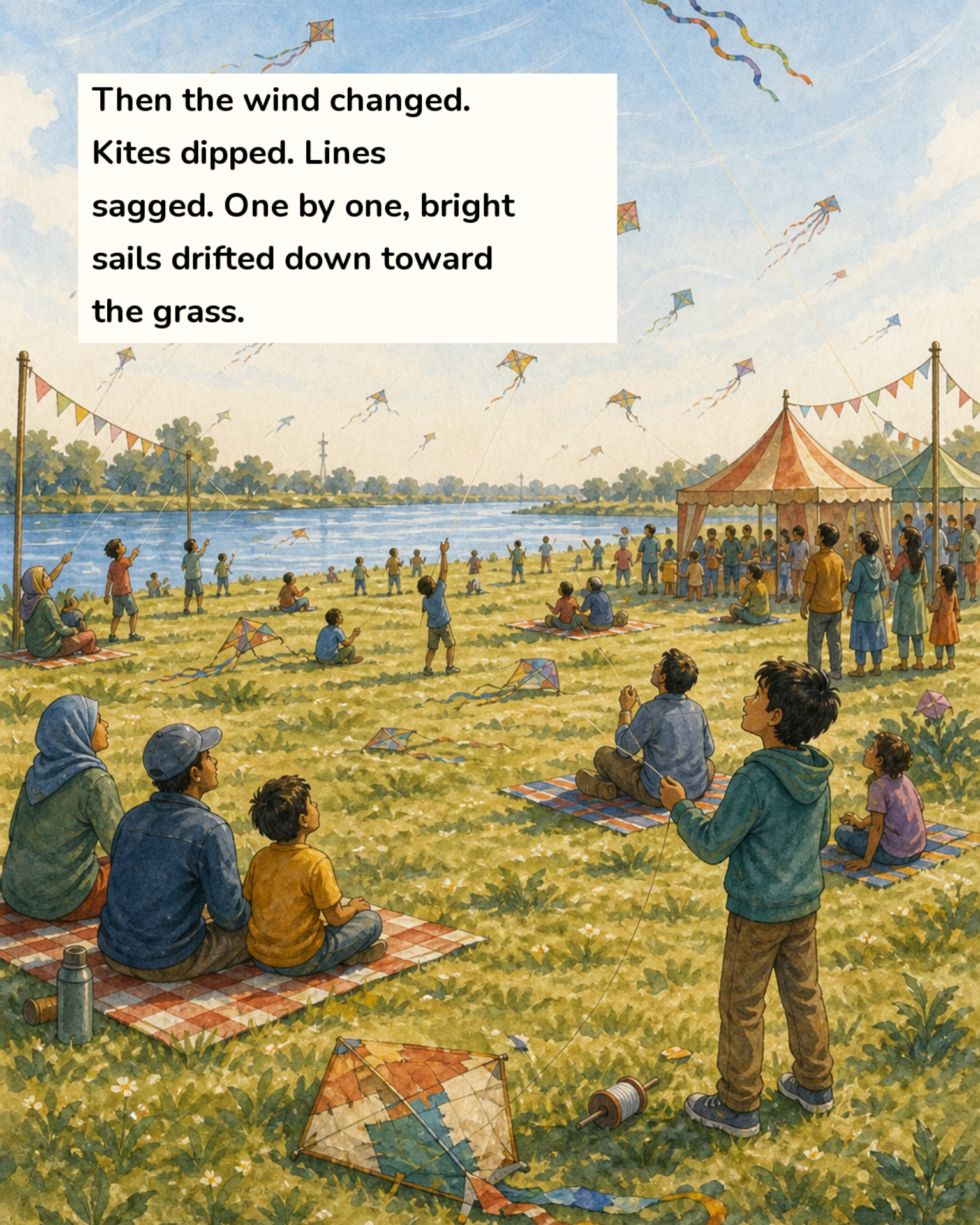
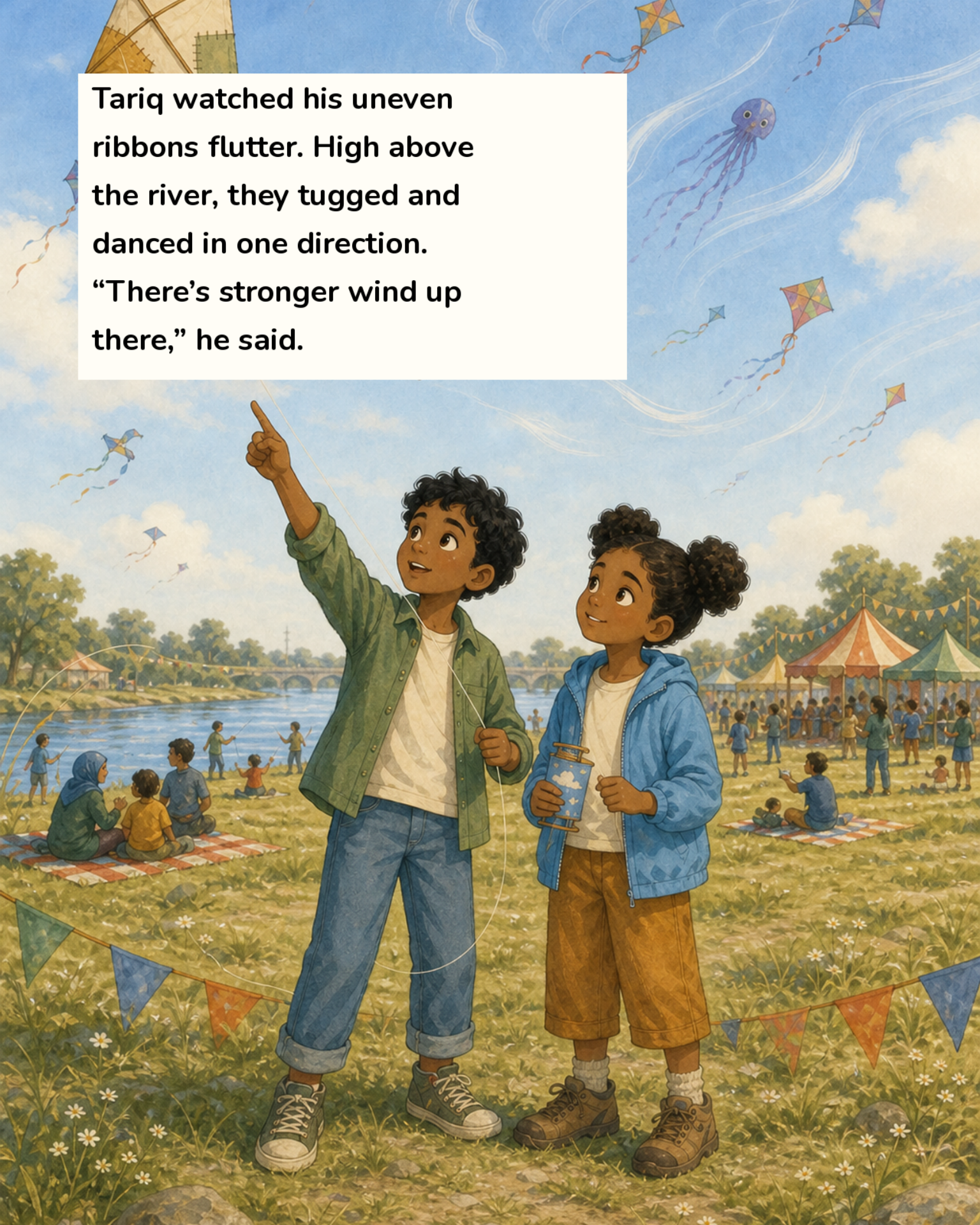
# Tariq Finds the Wind

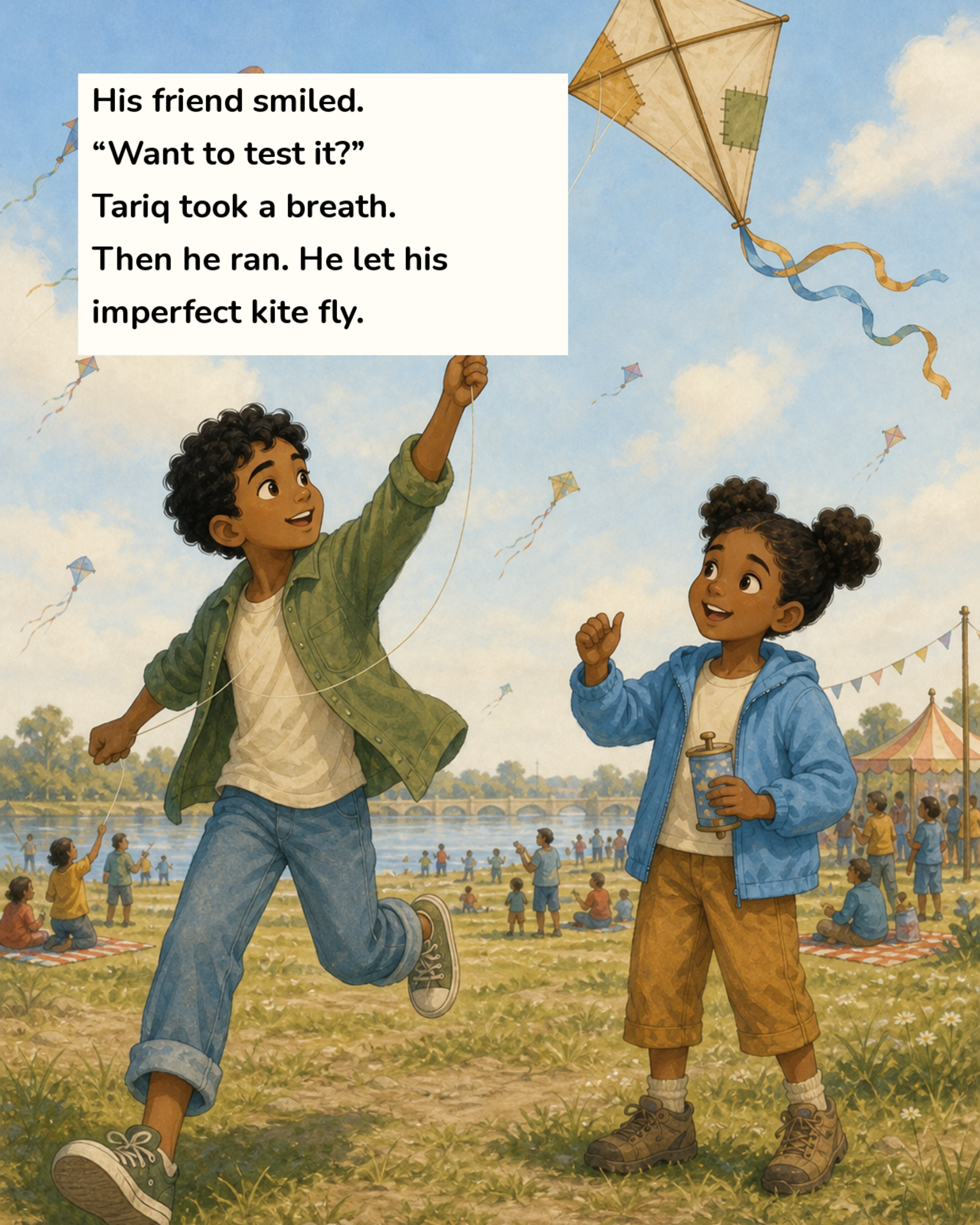
Tariq arrived at the riverside kite festival with his handmade kite tucked under one arm. Around him, polished kites flashed in the morning sun.

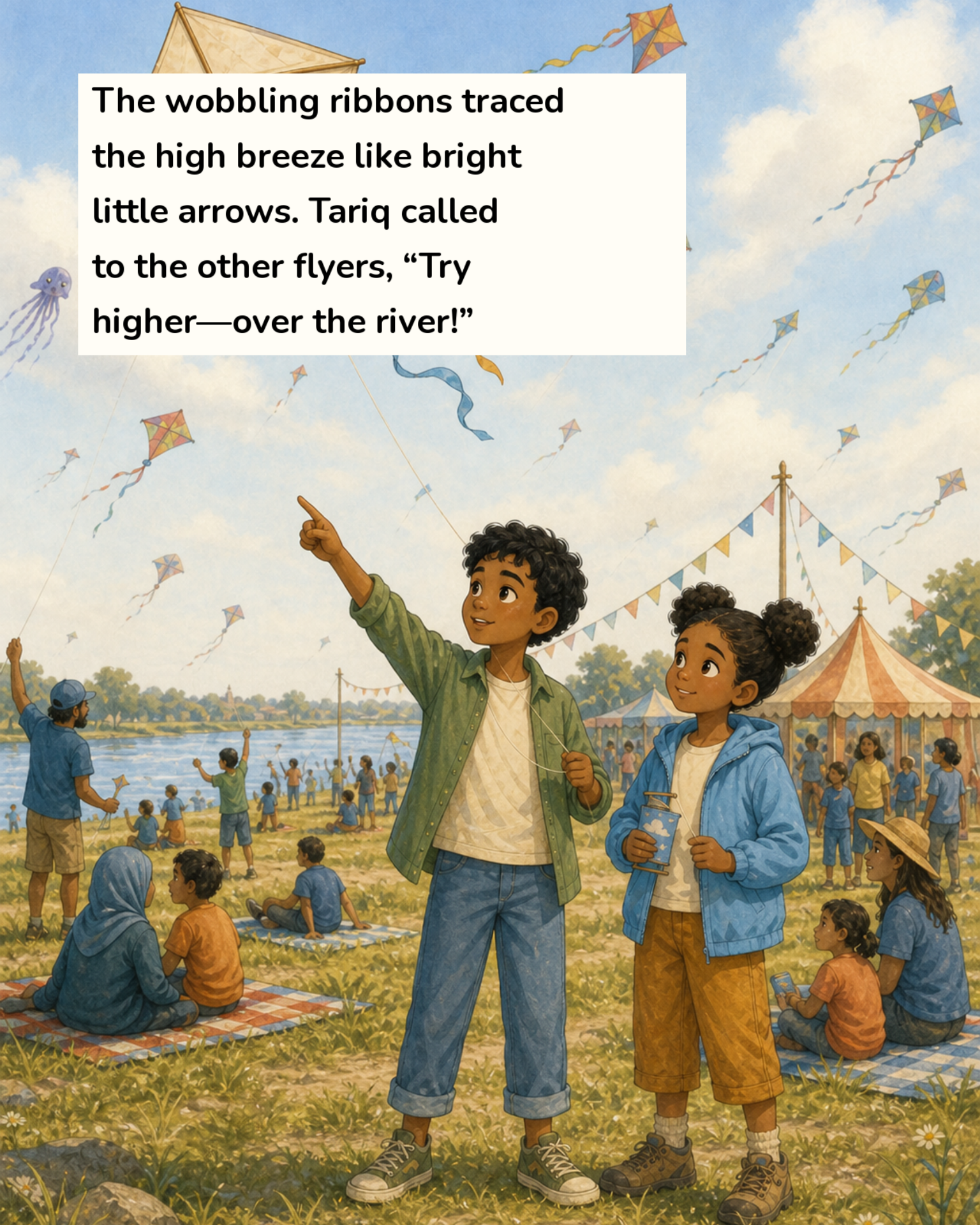
But his sail was patched, and its ribbon tail was uneven. “Maybe I should keep it hidden,” Tariq whispered.

A child in a sky-blue windbreaker stopped beside him. “What makes those ribbons wobble?” they asked. Tariq blinked. “The tail is uneven.”


Then the wind changed. Kites dipped. Lines sagged. One by one, bright sails drifted down toward the grass.


Tariq watched his uneven ribbons flutter. High above the river, they tugged and danced in one direction. “There’s stronger wind up there,” he said.


His friend smiled.
“Want to test it?”
Tariq took a breath.
Then he ran. He let his
imperfect kite fly.


The wobbling ribbons traced the high breeze like bright little arrows. Tariq called to the other flyers, “Try higher—over the river!”

Soon the sky filled with kites again. Tariq’s patched sail still wobbled proudly above the river. It did not have to be perfect to help everyone find the wind.